

TRADING EXCELLENCE

IIFT is known for its focus on international trade and economics. Now, with new campuses, it remains uniquely placed to make a mark for itself in the evolving global order

BY **SURABHI**

IN A WORLD where trade and tariffs have been a focal point, especially over the past few years, Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT) is uniquely placed, says its former vice chancellor Rakesh Mohan Joshi.

"IIFT is very distinct and more relevant in today's world because we focus on international trade and business, which has become a crucial issue. International trade and economy are incorporated in our teaching. We have programmes for MBA in international business. We have launched an MBA in business analytics, which is for database decision making. We also have a programme on MA in trade and economics," says Joshi, who joined IIFT as a faculty member in 2000, became the vice chancellor in May 2024, and superannuated from service on August 31, 2026.

IIFT has been ranked ninth in the *BT*-MDRA Best B-schools Survey 2026-27.

CONTEMPORARY COURSE DESIGN

While IIFT was set up in 1963 under the Department of Commerce to build skills for external trade, over the years, it has grown to become a national university known for its focus on research and training in international business, trade and strategy.

Joshi underlines that the institute includes contemporary issues in the syllabus. "The entire concept of globalisation is changing. Even trade theories are undergoing a change," he says.

IIFT has also reviewed the course curriculum after six years to make it up-to-date in AI, international negotiations, and sustainability.

The institute has also undertaken capacity building for faculty and staff on AI tools and advanced digital tools to improve efficiency.

The institute's two-year MBA in International Business Programme gives students exposure to live trade policy research projects and internships, and includes a port visit as part of the hands-on experience.

CAMPUS EXPANSION

A key focus area has been expanding and operationalising campuses. Joshi says one of the most important things he could do in his tenure as VC was to revitalise and operationalise two campuses—one at Kakinada in Andhra Pradesh and another in GIFT City, Gujarat. It also has a campus in Kolkata. "We now have four campuses in the country—in East, West, North, and South," he says.

IIFT's new Kakinada campus in Andhra Pradesh, which is spread across 25 acres, was completed on a war footing and received Occupation Certificate in June this year. While courses were going on previously, the new academic session has commenced in the new campus. "We are awaiting its for-

FOR THE MBA (IB) PROGRAMME, THE AVERAGE CTC STOOD AT ₹31.3 LAKH PER ANNUM, WITH A MEDIAN CTC OF ₹26 LAKH PER ANNUM